

Suren J. Mohammed

Computational Social Scientist
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Summary Statement

As a computational social scientist trained in political science and statistical computing, I uncover patterns in human behavior and use social science theories to explain the motivations behind those patterns, drawing on both conventional statistical methods and modern machine learning and AI techniques.

Professional & Research Experience

Data Scientist, Violence, Conflict, and Security Lab (ViCS) — University of Florida	Fall 2024 – Present
- Modeling: Built predictive models to evaluate competing theories of political violence onset worldwide (1942–2012); findings developed into manuscripts currently under review at leading journals. - Data Construction: Designed and deployed an AWS-based, real-time web-scraping system to generate novel data for a conflict-forecasting pipeline. - Collaboration: Coordinated with a cross-departmental team, Aerospace Engineering, to refine model accuracy and incorporate modern AI algorithms. - Model Performance: Improved out-of-sample AUC of the predictive models from 0.71 to 0.80 via feature engineering and calibration; reduced false positives by 18%	
Graduate Teaching Assistant — University of Florida	2023 – 2024
Graduate Research Assistant — Missouri State University	2021–2023

Education

Ph.D. Student, Political Science University of Florida GAINESVILLE, FLORIDA, UNITED STATES	Expected 2027
Major Field: Comparative Politics; Minor Field: Statistical Computing Dissertation: Explaining the Spatial Logic of Ethnic Violence	
Graduate Certificate in Digital Geography and GIS University of Florida GAINESVILLE, FLORIDA, UNITED STATES	Expected 2026
Master of Arts in Political Science University of Florida GAINESVILLE, FLORIDA, UNITED STATES	2023 – 2025
Master of Arts in International Affairs Missouri State University SPRINGFIELD, MISSOURI, UNITED STATES	2021 – 2023
Field: International Security	
Bachelor of Arts in International Studies American University of Iraq-Sulaimani SULAIMANI, KURDISTAN REGION, IRAQ	2017 – 2021
Major: International Security, Minor: Economics	

Statistical Skills

Data collection; Regression analysis; Bayesian statistics; Time-series; Survival analysis;
Observational causal inference; NLP; Machine learning; Spatial analysis

Computer Languages

- **Programming:** Python, R, SQL
- **Machine learning:** sklearn, caret
- **Spatial Analysis:** ArcGIS Pro
- **Cloud:** AWS(EC2)
- **Writing:** L^AT_EX

Human Languages

Kurdish(Native); English (Fluent); Arabic (Advanced); Persian (Intermediate)

Pee-reviewed Publications

Mohammed, Suren J. & Romano, David (2023). *The Kurdish Conflict in Turkey: The Central Role of Identity Recognition (or Lack Thereof)*. *Ethnopolitics*, 1–18.

Work under Review & in Progress

Mirilovic, Nikola; **Mohammed, Suren**; Siroky, David. *Great Power Politics and the Timing of Recognition: Evidence from Bangladesh, 1971–74*. Under review.

Mohammed, Suren J. *The Spatial Logic of Violence in Communal War: Evidence from Iraq (2003–2009)*. Expected Submission: Spring 2026.

Siroky, David; Wang, Yu; **Mohammed, Suren**; Dilruba, Tas. *Automating War and Peace: Introducing an AI Agent for Conflict Forecasting*. Expected Submission: Spring 2026.

Mohammed, Suren J & Siroky, David. *Detect–Predict: A Prospective Early-Warning System for Political Instability*. Data collection is underway.

Mohammed, Suren J. *The Logic of Insurgency Revisited: A Machine Learning Approach to Feasibility vs. Motivation*.

Trainings & Fellowships

Predoctoral Fellow — Gainesville, FL, United States

2023 – Present

- Violence, Conflict, and Security (ViCS) Lab, University of Florida.

Quantitative and Qualitative Research Training — Sulaimani, Iraq

2020

- UK Arts & Humanities Research Council (AHRC); Institute of Regional & International Studies (IRIS); and Global Public Policy Institute (GPPi).

Peace & Conflict Fellowship — Sulaimani, Iraq

2019

- Institute of Regional and International Studies (IRIS) and Global Public Policy Institute (GPPi).

Conferences

Northeastern Political Science Association — Boston, United States

2023

Peace Science Society — Orlando, United States

2025

Grants & Awards

Travel Grant-(\$350) — University of Florida,Florida

2023

Best Graduate Student Paper of the Year-(\$750) — University of Florida,Florida

2024-2025